

# VirtCruise Customer Support Playbook

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| Field           | Value                                                               |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document ID     | DOC-006                                                             |
| Version         | 0.8.0-draft.1                                                       |
| Product version | VirtCruise v0.7.0 with accepted Sprint 3.7 documentation            |
| Status          | Draft — Internal Review                                             |
| Owner           | Customer Support Lead                                               |
| Reviewer        | Product Owner, Operations Lead, Finance Lead, Security/Privacy Lead |
| Approver        | Business Owner                                                      |
| Classification  | Confidential — VirtCruise Internal Support Operations               |
| Last reviewed   | 2026-08-03                                                          |

## Contents

1. Purpose
2. Support team responsibilities
3. Support principles
4. Customer journey overview
5. Communication standards
6. Registration support
7. Sign-in support
8. Password reset support
9. Quote support
10. Booking support
11. Payment support
12. Manual Finance support
13. Receipt support

14. [Booking Confirmation support](#)
15. [Customer Portal support](#)
16. [Financial Portal support](#)
17. [Notifications](#)
18. [Frequently asked support questions](#)
19. [Complaint handling](#)
20. [Escalation procedures](#)
21. [Privacy](#)
22. [Security](#)
23. [Service outages](#)
24. [Support checklists](#)
25. [Glossary](#)
26. [Appendices](#)

# 1. Purpose

## Purpose

This playbook helps authorised support staff assist travellers consistently before, during, and after booking. It defines diagnosis, communication, ownership, privacy, and escalation practices for normal questions and service exceptions.

## Audience

- Customer Support staff and supervisors;
- operations users and consultants who share customer support work; and
- new support staff working under supervision.

## Scope

This playbook covers customer support for registration, email verification, sign-in, password reset, packages, quotes, bookings, payments, receipts, customer portals, notifications, complaints, incidents, privacy, and security. It reflects released v0.7.0 behaviour and accepted Sprint 3.7 documentation.

It does not authorise Support to change financial records, supply bank details, verify cleared funds, confirm payments, change booking status, grant access, or alter production services.

## Prerequisites

Support staff need approved access, identity-verification training, current contact and escalation registers, and familiarity with DOC-002. Staff handling financial or operational escalations must also understand the boundaries in DOC-003 and DOC-004.

## 2. Support team responsibilities

### Support staff

Support staff receive enquiries, verify identity proportionately, locate the correct customer-owned context, explain customer-visible states, complete safe first-line checks, record contacts, and escalate to the accountable team. They maintain communication ownership until a hand-off is acknowledged.

### Support supervisors

Supervisors coach staff, review sensitive or complex cases, control complaint quality, coordinate incidents, manage escalations, and confirm that support records meet privacy and professional standards.

### Consultants and Operations

Consultants own travel requirements, quote interpretation, and commercial conversations within their authority. Operations owns booking progression and operational exceptions. Support can coordinate but must not imply mutation rights that the product or policy does not provide.

### Prohibited actions

Support must never:

- ask for a password, verification link, password-reset link, or security code;
- invent, remember, repeat, or validate bank details;
- confirm cleared funds, a Payment, or a booking;
- expose internal comments or another customer's information;
- promise prices, availability, refunds, compensation, or response times without authority;
- speculate about causes or blame another person or team; or
- make direct financial, booking, permission, database, or production changes.

### 3. Support principles

| Principle           | Required behaviour                                                                   |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Professionalism     | Use calm, respectful, plain language and accurate records.                           |
| Empathy             | Acknowledge impact without making unsupported admissions or promises.                |
| Accuracy            | Check the authoritative record and distinguish fact from an unresolved question.     |
| Privacy             | Verify identity and disclose only what is necessary to the authorised customer.      |
| Ownership           | Coordinate the next action and keep the customer informed until hand-off or closure. |
| Response quality    | Answer the question, explain the next step, and give a safe reference.               |
| Customer confidence | Be transparent about known facts, uncertainty, and accountable ownership.            |

**Important:** Never promise unavailable functionality. If a control or workflow is future functionality, say that it is not currently available and offer the released alternative.

## 4. Customer journey overview

Discover packages

↓

Register → Verify email → Sign in

↓

Request quote → Review quote → Accept eligible quote

↓

Booking created → Finance instructions → Cleared-funds verification

↓

Payment recorded → Receipt issued → Booking status evaluated

↓

Booking Confirmation → Travel support → Completion

**Figure 1 — Customer journey and support hand-offs.** Support explains and diagnoses throughout. Consultants own quote and travel-content questions; Finance owns bank instructions and payment decisions; Operations owns booking progression.

### Keep records distinct

| Record or state            | Customer meaning                                           | Support boundary                                       |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Quote                      | Proposed travel arrangements and value                     | Explain; route changes to a consultant                 |
| Booking                    | Travel record created from an eligible quote               | Explain current state; route progression to Operations |
| Proof or bank confirmation | Evidence supplied by the customer or bank                  | Never treat as cleared funds                           |
| Payment                    | Authoritative financial record after approved verification | Finance confirms and records                           |
| Receipt                    | Evidence of an eligible recorded Payment                   | Not proof that the whole invoice is paid               |
| Booking Confirmation       | Authoritative booking outcome CONFIRMED                    | Never infer it from payment or a message alone         |

## 5. Communication standards

### Open a conversation

1. Greet the traveller and identify VirtCruise and yourself according to channel policy.
2. Ask how you can help and allow the traveller to explain.
3. Acknowledge the issue: “I understand you need help finding the status of your booking.”
4. Explain any identity check before requesting information.

### Collect information safely

Ask only for what the task needs: name, account email address, customer-safe reference, affected page, date/time, exact displayed message, and desired outcome. Do not request full card or bank information, account passwords, security codes, private links, or unrelated identity documents.

### Verify identity

Use the current approved verification policy. A booking reference or name alone may not be sufficient. If verification fails, explain that you cannot disclose protected details and escalate identity-recovery questions through the approved route.

### Explain a delay

Use known facts, the current owner, and the next update. For example: “Your transfer is not yet shown as a recorded Payment. Finance must verify cleared funds. I have sent your invoice reference to Finance through the approved route.” Do not supply an invented completion time.

### Close a conversation

1. Summarise the issue and action taken.
2. Confirm the customer-safe reference and communication owner.
3. State the next step without promising an unauthorised outcome.
4. Ask whether the traveller needs clarification.
5. Thank them and complete the support record.

### Channel etiquette

| Channel   | Standard                                                                                                              |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Email     | Verify recipient, use a clear subject, keep sensitive data minimal, and inspect attachments and links before sending. |
| Telephone | Protect conversations from being overheard, explain holds and transfers, and read references carefully.               |
| Chat      | Send concise messages, avoid requesting secrets, state when checking a record, and summarise before closing.          |

## Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 2: Approved support contact entry point** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Content: Customer help or contact route using fictional data. Alternative text: VirtCruise customer contact entry point showing approved support channels. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.



## 6. Registration support

### Help a traveller register

1. Confirm they are on the expected VirtCruise registration page.
2. Explain that first name, last name, email address, matching passwords, and acceptance of Terms and Privacy are required.
3. Explain the minimum 12-character password requirement without asking to see the password.
4. Ask them to read the field-specific message and correct only that field.
5. After submission, explain that the expected message is **Check your email to verify your account**.
6. If email is missing, ask them to check spam, junk, and the entered address.
7. Escalate repeated delivery failure with UTC time and safe account email context.

**Expected outcome:** The traveller receives the general check-your-email result and can complete email verification.

**Warning:** Never ask the customer to forward a verification link. Links are private and may expire or be replaced by newer requests.

### Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 3: Registration and verification support** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Content: Empty registration form and check-your-email state; fictional data only. Alternative text: Registration form and email-verification instruction used during customer support. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

## 7. Sign-in support

### Diagnose sign-in safely

1. Ask the traveller to confirm the email address spelling privately on their own screen.
2. Confirm they have completed email verification.
3. Ask whether they use email/password, Google, or Facebook; the sign-in method must match the account association.
4. Ask them to re-enter the password without sharing it.
5. Recommend **Forgot password?** rather than repeated guessing.
6. If the sign-in expired, explain that they must sign in again and may return to the protected page.
7. Escalate repeated errors with time, route, browser family, and exact customer-visible wording.

**Expected outcome:** The traveller signs in or moves safely to password recovery.

**Important: Remember me** remembers the email address on a private device; it is not a reason to use a shared device without signing out.

## 8. Password reset support

### Guide password recovery

1. Direct the traveller to **Sign In > Forgot password?**.
2. Ask them to enter their own email address and select **Send reset instructions**.
3. Explain that the general confirmation protects account privacy and does not reveal whether an account exists.
4. Ask them to check the newest message, including spam or junk.
5. Advise using only the newest reset link.
6. Ask them to enter and confirm a strong new password privately.
7. If unsuccessful, record the time and error wording and escalate without collecting the link.

**Expected outcome:** The new password is accepted and the traveller can sign in.

**Warning:** Support must never receive, open, test, or store a password-reset link or proposed password.

### Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 4: Sign-in and password reset** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Content: Empty sign-in form, **Forgot password?**, and general reset confirmation. Alternative text: Sign-in and password-recovery controls used during a safe support conversation. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

## 9. Quote support

### Help with a quote

1. Verify the customer before opening protected quote details.
2. Match the quote number, destination, or package name.
3. Distinguish a quote request from a prepared quote.
4. Ask the customer to review dates, travellers, services, notes, value, and status.
5. Explain that **Accept quote** appears only for an eligible quote.
6. If the control is available and the customer chooses to proceed, advise selecting it once and waiting.
7. Check **My Bookings** before treating an ambiguous response as failure.
8. Route itinerary, availability, price, or commercial changes to the consultant.

**Expected outcome:** The customer understands the quote state and either completes an available action or reaches the responsible consultant.

**Warning:** A quote is not a booking, and accepting a quote does not by itself confirm travel.

## 10. Booking support

### Answer a booking-status enquiry

1. Verify identity and match the exact booking reference.
2. Open the current booking details available within your role.
3. Read the current commercial booking status, not a notification or payment assumption.
4. Review customer-visible dates, travellers, services, and payment summary.
5. Explain the current next action from DOC-002.
6. Route changes or progression exceptions to Operations or the consultant.
7. Route payment consequences to Finance.

Key customer-visible statuses include `PENDING_CUSTOMER_ACCEPTANCE`, `ACCEPTED`, `DEPOSIT_PENDING`, `DEPOSIT_RECEIVED`, `CONFIRMED`, `DOCUMENTS_PENDING`, `READY_TO_TRAVEL`, `IN_PROGRESS`, `COMPLETED`, `CANCELLED`, and `REFUNDED`. Do not change or reinterpret an accepted label.

### Cancellation enquiry

If **Cancel booking** is available, explain that an online cancellation request cannot be undone online and conditions may apply. Never promise the cancellation result, charge, or refund. Route uncertainty to Operations and Finance before the traveller acts.

### Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 5: Booking status support** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile  
Content: Fictional booking details, status, timeline, and payment summary. Alternative text:  
Customer booking details used to explain the current status and next action. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

# 11. Payment support

## Handle a payment question

1. Verify identity and match the booking or invoice reference.
2. Ask what the customer sees in **Finances**, without requesting full banking information.
3. Confirm the relevant currency and amount from the authoritative record.
4. Distinguish transfer sent, cleared funds, Payment recorded, Receipt issued, and booking confirmed.
5. If instructions or verification are needed, transfer to Finance.
6. If a Payment is absent, tell the customer not to send a duplicate transfer while Finance checks.
7. Record the Finance hand-off and maintain customer communication ownership.

**Warning:** Support never confirms payment. A bank confirmation or proof does not establish cleared funds or an authoritative Payment.

## 12. Manual Finance support

### Current production behaviour

Manual Finance is the released mode. **Pay by Bank Transfer** tells the traveller to contact Finance and shows the invoice reference and currency, but no destination bank details. Finance supplies approved instructions outside the customer self-service flow and independently verifies cleared funds.

Support must:

1. Direct the traveller to the approved Finance contact route shown by VirtCruise.
2. Ask them to quote the exact invoice or booking reference and currency.
3. Explain that Finance supplies and verifies payment instructions.
4. Explain that the booking remains pending until cleared funds are verified and the eligible Payment is recorded.
5. Transfer missing-payment or instruction questions to Finance.

Support must not:

- state, copy, confirm, or reconstruct bank details;
- advise reuse of details from an earlier booking or message;
- request proof through an unapproved channel;
- say that money is received because the customer sent proof; or
- say that the booking is confirmed before authoritative status is **CONFIRMED**.

### Future functionality — Self Service

Customer-visible bank details, automated review-case creation, proof upload, review tracking, and replacement proof controls are not available in production Manual Finance Mode. Do not instruct customers to look for them.

### Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 6: Manual Finance customer hand-off** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Content: Contact-Finance panel, fictional reference and currency, and no bank details. Alternative text: Manual Finance page directing the traveller to Finance for payment instructions. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

## 13. Receipt support

### Help locate a Receipt

1. Verify identity and match the Payment or booking reference.
2. Ask the customer to open **Finances > Receipts**.
3. Check the currency, amount, issue date, Payment reference, and booking link where shown.
4. Explain that one Receipt records one eligible Payment and does not necessarily mean the invoice is fully paid.
5. If the Payment exists but its Receipt does not appear, refresh once, check authoritative status where authorised, and escalate to Finance/Operations.
6. Do not promise PDF download; it is future functionality.

**Expected outcome:** The customer locates the Receipt or Finance receives a bounded missing-record enquiry.



## 14. Booking Confirmation support

### Confirm what the system says

1. Verify identity and open the exact booking.
2. Read the current booking status.
3. Treat only **CONFIRMED** as Booking Confirmation.
4. Explain that a recorded Payment, a Receipt, or a payment message can exist before confirmation depending on booking and deposit policy.
5. If full settlement appears complete but the booking has not progressed, escalate to Operations; do not alter or promise the state.
6. If a confirmation message is missing, check notification state through the authorised route without resending blindly.

**Expected outcome:** The traveller receives an accurate statement based on authoritative booking status.

## 15. Customer Portal support

The Customer Portal includes the Dashboard, **My Quotes**, **My Bookings**, **Finances**, **My Trips**, **Travellers**, **Profile**, and **Notifications**. A Dashboard summary is orientation, not a substitute for detailed records.

### Diagnose a portal issue

1. Confirm the traveller is signed in and viewing their own account.
2. Ask which named area and record is affected.
3. Ask them to open the detailed page directly from portal navigation.
4. Refresh once after confirming no action is still processing.
5. Explain that empty states can be correct for a new account.
6. For profile and preference details, explain that expanded data currently uses browser-only storage and may not follow the customer to another device.
7. Escalate persistent failure with safe page, time, browser, and reference information.

### Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 7: Customer Dashboard support** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile Content: Dashboard and portal navigation using fictional customer activity. Alternative text: Customer Dashboard with routes to quotes, bookings, finances, trips, profile, and notifications. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

## 16. Financial Portal support

The released Financial Portal is customer-owned and read-only. It shows invoices and deposits, Payments, Receipts, refunds, and per-currency balances. It does not initiate payment, combine currencies, offer a customer ledger, or provide Receipt PDF download.

### Diagnose a financial display question

1. Verify identity and ask the traveller to open **Finances**.
2. Identify whether the question concerns **Invoices**, **Payments**, **Receipts**, or **Refunds**.
3. Match the exact reference and currency.
4. Explain that searches and filters apply to the currently loaded page.
5. Never combine currency balances or interpret an outstanding balance as permission to pay.
6. Route missing or disputed financial records to Finance.

### Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 8: Financial Portal support** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile  
Content: Financial Overview and one fictional single-currency invoice. Alternative text: Read-only Financial Portal showing invoice, Payment, Receipt, and refund navigation. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

# 17. Notifications

## Support a missing notification

1. Identify the expected business event and confirm that it actually occurred.
2. Ask the customer to check **Notifications**, email inbox, spam, and junk.
3. Verify the account email address without exposing it to an unauthorised person.
4. Check the authorised notification status or escalate to Operations.
5. For retry pending, explain that delivery is still being attempted.
6. For failed or manual intervention, route to the responsible operations owner.
7. For uncertain delivery, do not resend blindly; confirm the authoritative attempt state first.
8. Record any approved manual communication.

Browser and mobile push notifications are future functionality. Do not promise them.

## Screenshot placeholder

**Screenshot required — Figure 9: Customer notifications** Views: Desktop, Tablet, Mobile  
Content: Fictional customer-safe notification list and empty state. Alternative text: Customer notification area showing booking and financial updates. Capture required after WEB-006 acceptance.

## 18. Frequently asked support questions

### Access and registration

1. **What information is needed to register?** First name, last name, email address, matching passwords of at least 12 characters, and acceptance of Terms and Privacy.
2. **Why must the customer verify their email?** Verification establishes access to that email address before protected account use.
3. **Can I activate an account for the customer?** No. Guide them through the approved verification process or escalate a genuine delivery fault.
4. **Can I ask for the verification link?** No. It is private; ask the customer to use the newest message themselves.
5. **Why did the registration form reject the password?** Ask the customer to read the field message and create a private password of at least 12 characters.
6. **What if verification email is missing?** Check spam, junk, the entered address, and timing, then escalate repeated delivery failure.
7. **Can Support reveal whether an email has an account?** Follow privacy policy and general responses; do not disclose account existence to an unverified caller.
8. **What if the customer used Google or Facebook?** They should use the same method associated with their VirtCruise account.
9. **What does an expired sign-in mean?** The secure sign-in ended; ask the customer to sign in again.
10. **What if access is denied after sign-in?** Confirm the route belongs to the customer role, then escalate with the safe error details.

### Password reset and portal

1. **Why is the reset confirmation general?** It protects privacy by not revealing whether an account exists.
2. **Which reset email should the customer use?** The newest one.
3. **Can Support choose a password for a customer?** No. The customer creates it privately.
4. **Can a customer send me a reset link to test?** No. Never receive, open, or store it.
5. **Why is the Dashboard empty?** A new account may have no matching records; check the detailed page.
6. **Why are profile changes missing on another device?** Expanded profile and preference data currently uses browser-only storage.
7. **Can Support restore browser-only profile data?** Not from the authoritative account. Explain the limitation and escalate only an unexpected product fault.
8. **Can customers upload passport documents?** Not through a released passport upload. Do not request them through an unapproved route.

### Packages, quotes, and bookings

1. **Does a package page guarantee availability?** No. Availability and final arrangements follow the quote and booking process.
2. **Is the displayed package price final?** Not necessarily; the personalised quote is the relevant offer.

3. **What is the difference between a request and a quote?** A request describes needs; a quote is the offer prepared from them.
4. **Where are quotes shown?** Under **My Quotes** after sign-in.
5. **Why is Accept quote missing?** It appears only for an eligible quote; check status or involve the consultant.
6. **What if Accept quote appeared to do nothing?** Wait, then check **My Bookings** before repeating the action.
7. **Does accepting a quote confirm travel?** No. It creates a booking; further payment and operational checks may apply.
8. **Where is a new booking?** It should open after acceptance and appear in **My Bookings**.
9. **Can Support change a booking?** No. Route commercial changes and progression to the responsible consultant or Operations.
10. **Can Support cancel a booking?** No. Explain the available customer action and route policy or financial questions.
11. **Can Support promise a cancellation refund?** No. Finance and applicable terms determine financial consequences.
12. **What does Deposit Pending mean?** A required deposit has not yet been verified as received.
13. **What status confirms travel?** The authoritative booking status **CONFIRMED**.
14. **What if a direct message conflicts with the portal?** Ask the customer not to act and escalate the discrepancy using the exact booking reference.

## Payments and receipts

1. **Can customers pay inside VirtCruise?** No online payment control is released; current production uses Manual Finance.
2. **Why are bank details absent?** Finance supplies approved instructions for the correct invoice and currency.
3. **Can Support provide bank details?** No. Transfer the customer to the approved Finance route.
4. **Can Support confirm bank details the customer reads out?** No. Finance must handle that verification through an approved route.
5. **What reference should the customer provide?** The authoritative invoice or booking reference requested by Finance.
6. **Does proof mean payment was received?** No. Finance must independently verify cleared funds.
7. **Can Support confirm payment?** No. Check the customer-visible record and route the decision to Finance.
8. **Should the customer send another transfer?** Not while the first is unresolved; involve Finance to avoid duplication.
9. **Why is a transfer not shown immediately?** It may not have cleared or been matched and recorded yet.
10. **Where are Payments shown?** Under **Finances > Payments**.
11. **Where are Receipts shown?** Under **Finances > Receipts**.
12. **Does a Receipt mean the invoice is fully paid?** Not necessarily; it records one eligible Payment.
13. **Can a customer download a Receipt PDF?** Not currently; that is future functionality.
14. **Can Support combine balances in different currencies?** No. Each currency must be considered separately.

15. **What if Payment exists but Receipt is missing?** Refresh once, verify the record, and escalate to Finance/Operations rather than recreating anything.
16. **What if the customer disputes an amount?** Record the exact reference, currency, and customer statement, then escalate to Finance.

## Notifications, complaints, privacy, and incidents

1. **Where do customer messages appear?** In **Notifications** and, for eligible events, by email.
2. **Are push notifications available?** No. Browser and mobile push are future functionality.
3. **Should I resend a message marked uncertain?** No. Check the authoritative delivery state first.
4. **What if email is delayed?** Confirm the business event, check notification status, and set accurate expectations.
5. **What starts complaint handling?** Listen, acknowledge impact, verify identity, and record facts and desired resolution.
6. **Can I admit liability to show empathy?** Acknowledge impact without making an unsupported admission or promise.
7. **When should a supervisor join?** Follow policy for serious, repeated, sensitive, vulnerable-customer, or unresolved cases.
8. **Can I share internal comments with a customer?** No. Summarise only approved customer-safe facts.
9. **Can I include another customer's record in a screenshot?** No. Stop, mask at source with fictional data, and report any exposure.
10. **What if account compromise is suspected?** Pause unsafe action, preserve facts, and escalate to Security immediately.
11. **What if VirtCruise is unavailable?** Check the approved incident source, use authorised wording, and offer safe alternatives.
12. **Can I promise when service will return?** Only when the incident owner has approved a specific statement.
13. **What evidence helps a technical escalation?** Safe page name, UTC time, browser family, exact message, customer-safe reference, and steps attempted.
14. **Should I speculate about the cause?** No. State known impact and next action.
15. **Who owns customer updates after escalation?** Support until a documented hand-off assigns another communication owner.
16. **When is a case closed?** When the answer, resolution, or acknowledged hand-off is recorded and communicated clearly.

# 19. Complaint handling

## Listen, investigate, escalate, follow up, close

1. **Listen:** Allow the traveller to explain and acknowledge the impact.
2. **Investigate:** Verify identity, gather minimum facts, inspect authoritative records, and separate fact from allegation.
3. **Escalate:** Route financial, operational, management, privacy, or security decisions to the accountable role.
4. **Follow up:** Give the case reference and next approved update; maintain ownership.
5. **Close:** Explain the resolution or final position, record acceptance or remaining disagreement, and provide the approved next route.

**Example:** “I understand the delay has affected your planning. The booking currently shows DEPOSIT\_PENDING, and Finance must verify the transfer. I have escalated invoice reference VC-INV-EXAMPLE through the approved Finance route. We will update you through this support case.”

**Example:** Avoid “Finance lost your payment and will confirm it today.” This assigns unverified blame and promises an outcome.

## Complaint record

Record customer wording fairly, observed facts, requested resolution, related references, impact, steps taken, escalation, communication, and outcome. Do not include insults, speculation, unnecessary sensitive data, or internal discussion presented as fact.

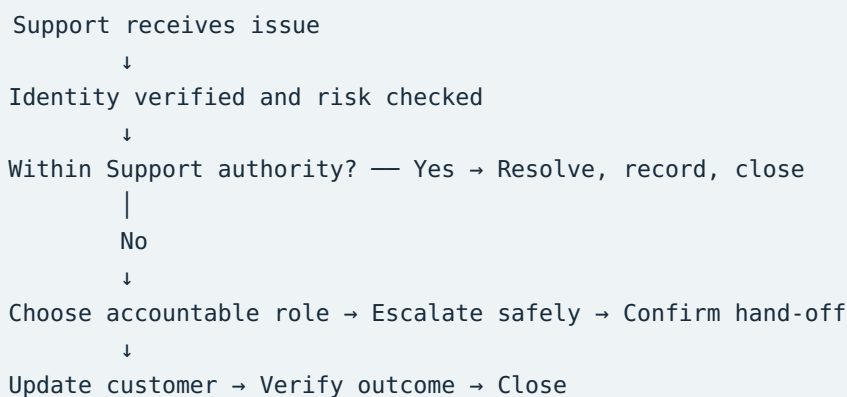


## 20. Escalation procedures

### Escalate safely

1. Identify risk and pause unsafe action.
2. Choose the accountable role from the [Support Escalation Matrix](#).
3. Prepare a concise record with customer-safe reference, UTC time, impact, observed state, and checks completed.
4. Remove secrets and unnecessary personal or financial data.
5. Send through the approved internal route.
6. Obtain an escalation reference and receiving owner.
7. Tell the customer what can safely be shared and who owns the next update.
8. Follow through until acknowledged and closed.

Escalation contacts and response targets are policy-owned. Use [Finance route], [Operations route], [Technical route], [Administrator route], [Management route], and [Security route] only as controlled placeholders until approved values are inserted in the restricted register.



**Figure 10 — Support resolution and escalation flow.** Security or privacy risk bypasses routine handling and uses the approved urgent route.

## 21. Privacy

### Protect customer information

- Use least-privilege access and open only the record required.
- Verify identity before disclosing booking, financial, profile, or travel information.
- Prefer authoritative references over broad searches by name.
- Never expose internal comments, unrelated records, or another traveller's details.
- Share screens only after closing unrelated windows and masking nonessential information.
- Use fictional data for screenshots; opaque masking is required if replacement at source is impossible.
- Do not copy customer or financial data to personal devices, unapproved spreadsheets, email, or messaging tools.
- Follow approved retention, printing, clean-desk, and disposal rules.
- Report accidental disclosure immediately; do not conceal or redistribute it.

## 22. Security

### Recognise and respond

Warning signs include unexpected bank-detail changes, pressure to bypass verification, requests for another customer's data, suspicious links or files, repeated failed sign-ins, account details changed without authority, and claims of unauthorised access.

1. Pause the action that could increase harm.
2. Do not open suspicious files or links beyond approved security handling.
3. Preserve the original support record and timestamps.
4. Tell the customer only safe protective steps within approved guidance.
5. Escalate immediately through [\[Security route\]](#).

**Warning:** Do not conduct a criminal or technical investigation. Preserve records and involve Security.

## 23. Service outages

### Incident response

1. Confirm the approved incident source or escalation owner; do not rely on customer reports alone.
2. Record the affected customer function, start time if known, and observable impact.
3. Use the incident owner's approved wording and update cadence.
4. Offer only safe alternatives that do not bypass identity, Finance, booking, or security controls.
5. Record affected customer cases and urgent travel impact.
6. Correct earlier advice if the authorised incident statement changes.

### Customer wording

| Situation                  | Safe wording                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| System unavailable         | "VirtCruise is currently unavailable for some customers. The service team is investigating. Please do not repeat a booking or payment action." |
| Delayed payment processing | "Your transfer is not yet shown as a recorded Payment. Finance is checking the approved records; please do not send a duplicate transfer."     |
| Notification delay         | "The underlying record is [known state]. The message is delayed, and the delivery status is being checked."                                    |
| Email problem              | "Please check spam and junk. We are checking delivery; we will not ask for your password or private link."                                     |
| Maintenance                | "Planned maintenance is affecting [approved scope]. Use the approved return time only if published by the incident owner."                     |
| Partial outage             | "Some VirtCruise functions are affected. [Approved unaffected function] remains available; do not repeat an uncertain transaction."            |

Do not state a cause, recovery time, data-loss conclusion, or financial outcome unless approved by the incident owner.

## 24. Support checklists

Use the printable [Support Checklists](#):

- Call checklist;
- Email checklist;
- Booking checklist;
- Payment enquiry checklist;
- Complaint checklist; and
- Escalation checklist.

Supervisors must review the checklists when product behaviour, approved policy, support channels, or incident learning changes.

## 25. Glossary

| Term                  | Meaning                                                                                             |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Allocation            | The part of a recorded Payment applied to an invoice.                                               |
| Authoritative state   | The current approved system record used for a business decision.                                    |
| Booking               | A customer-owned travel record created from an eligible quote.                                      |
| Booking Confirmation  | The authoritative booking outcome <b>CONFIRMED</b> .                                                |
| Booking reference     | Customer-safe reference used to identify a booking accurately.                                      |
| Cleared funds         | Money independently verified as available in the approved destination account.                      |
| Complaint             | An expression of dissatisfaction requiring response or resolution.                                  |
| Customer Dashboard    | Customer starting page summarising recent travel activity and common tasks.                         |
| Customer Portal       | Protected customer area for quotes, bookings, finances, trips, profile, and notifications.          |
| Escalation            | Controlled hand-off to a role with the required authority or expertise.                             |
| Financial Portal      | Read-only customer area for invoices, Payments, Receipts, refunds, and per-currency balances.       |
| Identity verification | Approved checks before protected information is discussed or changed.                               |
| Incident              | Unplanned service disruption or degradation requiring coordinated response.                         |
| Internal comment      | Staff-only operational note that must never be disclosed as customer content.                       |
| Invoice               | Financial record showing an amount charged or due in a stated currency.                             |
| Manual Finance        | Current production mode where Finance supplies bank instructions and verifies cleared funds.        |
| Notification          | Customer-safe message about an eligible account or business event.                                  |
| Outstanding balance   | Amount still due for a specific invoice and currency.                                               |
| Payment               | Authoritative financial record created after approved verification.                                 |
| Proof                 | Customer-supplied evidence that does not itself establish cleared funds.                            |
| Quote                 | Customer-visible offer prepared from travel requirements.                                           |
| Receipt               | Record issued for one eligible recorded Payment.                                                    |
| Reference             | Customer-safe identifier for matching a quote, booking, invoice, Payment, Receipt, or support case. |
| Self Service          | Future bank-transfer capability not active in production Manual Finance Mode.                       |

| Term                | Meaning                                                                                 |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Secure sign-in      | Protected access established after successful authentication.                           |
| Support case        | Approved record of a customer enquiry and its handling.                                 |
| Support owner       | Person or team responsible for the next customer update.                                |
| Terms               | Approved commercial conditions governing the relevant service or booking.               |
| Verification link   | Private, time-limited route used by the customer to verify an email address.            |
| Vulnerable customer | Traveller whose circumstances require support to apply approved additional-care policy. |

## 26. Appendices

### Appendix A — Customer-safe information collection

| Useful when relevant                                         | Never collect through ordinary Support         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Page or feature name                                         | Password or proposed password                  |
| UTC date and time                                            | Verification or reset link                     |
| Quote, booking, invoice, Payment, Receipt, or case reference | One-time security code                         |
| Currency and amount shown by VirtCruise                      | Full bank or card credentials                  |
| Exact customer-visible error message                         | Authentication token or private technical data |
| Browser family and device type                               | Unnecessary passport or identity documents     |

### Appendix B — Safe wording library

| Topic        | Approved pattern                                                                                                                 |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Under review | "The current record is being reviewed by [authorised role]. It has not yet reached [outcome]."                                   |
| Payment      | "The transfer is not yet shown as a recorded Payment. Finance must verify cleared funds."                                        |
| Receipt      | "A Receipt appears after an eligible Payment is recorded. It does not by itself confirm full settlement."                        |
| Booking      | "The booking currently shows [status] . We will not describe it as confirmed until it shows CONFIRMED ."                         |
| Delay        | "I have recorded the impact and escalated it through [approved route]. I will update this support case when the owner responds." |
| Security     | "Please stop using the unexpected instruction or link. We are escalating this through the approved security route."              |

### Appendix C — Screenshot capture register

| Figure | Subject                       | Masking                         | Required views            | Dependency         |
|--------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------|
| 2      | Support contact entry         | Fictional contact and case data | Desktop/Tablet/<br>Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |
| 3      | Registration and verification | Empty form; fictional email     | Desktop/Tablet/<br>Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |
| 4      | Sign-in and reset             | Empty fields; no private links  | Desktop/Tablet/<br>Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |



| Figure | Subject            | Masking                              | Required views        | Dependency         |
|--------|--------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| 5      | Booking status     | Fictional traveller and booking      | Desktop/Tablet/Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |
| 6      | Manual Finance     | Fictional reference; no bank details | Desktop/Tablet/Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |
| 7      | Customer Dashboard | Fictional activity only              | Desktop/Tablet/Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |
| 8      | Financial Portal   | Fictional single-currency records    | Desktop/Tablet/Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |
| 9      | Notifications      | Fictional recipient and messages     | Desktop/Tablet/Mobile | WEB-006 acceptance |

All captures must follow DOC-001 Screenshot Standards and receive a second-person privacy inspection. No screenshot is fabricated for this draft.

## Appendix D — Handover note template

- Support case: [reference]
- Customer verification: [completed/not completed]
- Related business reference: [reference]
- Current authoritative state: [state]
- Customer impact and travel proximity: [facts]
- Checks completed: [safe summary]
- Customer wording used: [summary]
- Escalated to and route: [role/route]
- Escalation reference: [reference]
- Next customer update owner: [role]
- Approved update target: [policy value and time zone]

## Appendix E — New starter quick procedure

1. Read DOC-002 and the boundaries in this playbook.
2. Complete identity-verification, privacy, security, complaint, and escalation training.
3. Observe approved customer contacts under supervision.
4. Use the [Support Checklists](#).
5. Escalate whenever an action requires Finance, Operations, Administrator, Management, Technical Operations, or Security authority.
6. Work independently only after the Support Supervisor records approval.

## Related documents

- [DOC-002, VirtCruise Customer User Guide](#)
- [DOC-003, VirtCruise Back Office Operations Manual](#)
- [DOC-004, VirtCruise Finance Standard Operating Procedures](#)

- [DOC-005, Content Studio User Guide](#)
- [Customer Bank Transfer](#)
- [Financial Portal](#)
- [Manual Finance Launch Mode](#)
- [Support Checklists](#)
- [Support Escalation Matrix](#)

## Scope exclusions and future manuals

This playbook does not replace:

- DOC-003, VirtCruise Back Office Operations Manual;
- DOC-004, VirtCruise Finance Standard Operating Procedures;
- DOC-005, Content Studio User Guide;
- future DOC-007, Status and Lifecycle Reference;
- future DOC-009, Training Manual; or
- future DOC-010, Production Handover Guide.

It does not contain Finance decision policy, content publishing procedure, authoritative lifecycle definitions, complete training curricula, production commands, credentials, database guidance, or developer troubleshooting.

## Review record

| Gate                    | Responsible role      | Decision | Date | Evidence/notes                                             |
|-------------------------|-----------------------|----------|------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Support review          | Customer Support Lead | Pending  | —    | Validate contact and complaint procedures                  |
| Operations review       | Operations Lead       | Pending  | —    | Validate booking and incident boundaries                   |
| Finance review          | Finance Lead          | Pending  | —    | Validate Manual Finance wording                            |
| Privacy/security review | Security/Privacy Lead | Pending  | —    | Validate verification, disclosure, and escalation controls |
| Business approval       | Business Owner        | Pending  | —    | Required before operational publication                    |

## Change history

| Version       | Date       | Author             | Change                                    | Status                  |
|---------------|------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 0.8.0-draft.1 | 2026-08-03 | Documentation Team | Initial DOC-006 Customer Support Playbook | Draft — Internal Review |